

How to Choose a Laser Printer For Your Business

Small businesses face many challenges while trying to find a decent laser printer that meets most of their needs in a cost effective way. Here's a close look at some of the laser printers that are making steady inroads in the Indian market.



Printers have revolutionised the way we do business and play a key role in empowering small and medium sized businesses to achieve more with a reliable print environment. It's hard to imagine even the smallest of businesses being able to manage through without a high quality printer. But the sheer range of printers in the market is indeed confusing and choosing a good model for one's business can be a daunting task.

In such a scenario, you can opt for laser printers as these are increasingly being adopted by small and medium sized businesses (SMBs) and enterprises.

Why buy a laser printer?

SMBs and enterprises prefer laser printers over the conventional ink printers, because the images produced are more clear, crisp and vibrant. Besides, laser printers can produce more prints at faster speeds.

Laser printers are more expensive than inkjet printers, but the cost of printing per page is a lot less. This is because more pages can be printed with laser printers, and their toner and drum last for long. So, if you have high volume printing needs and yet wish to maximise your investment in an affordable manner, a premium quality laser printer can be a smart buy.

What to look for while buying a laser printer

Here are a few factors you should consider while purchasing your new laser printer.

Resolution: This is measured in dots per inch (dpi), and the higher the resolution, the better the image quality. Look for a minimum resolution of 600x600 dpi for plain text, and 1200x600 dpi to 5760x1440 dpi for photos.

Speed: Check out a system's printing speed before you consider buying a laser printer. The speed of a printer is rated in PPM, or pages per minute, and ranges anywhere between 4 and 10+ PPM, depending on several factors such as whether it is printing in black and white or colour, text only (with blank margins) or a full page. Laser printers have a quicker PPM than inkjet printers.

Paper handling: Many of us do not consider this as a significant criterion while buying a printer, but the way a printer handles and distributes the paper, matters. It is advisable to go for a printer that can handle the types of paper you want to use. Some models can print text and images to letter-size paper, legal-size paper, and envelopes, depending on the print options you choose. If you often need to print on different-sized paper, check out printers with many paper trays, and note the capacity of each tray. Many laser printers feature large paper trays for high-volume jobs. High-end printers may offer multiple output trays, collators, and automatic staplers. Also, if you tend to scan or copy multiple sheets of paper, go in for a multi-function printer with an automatic sheet feeder (ADF), so you don't have to feed each sheet of paper individually.

Memory: If you thought only computers and smartphones have an on-board processor and memory, think again. Printers, too, are armed with this feature. The higher the memory, the more effectively can a laser printer handle several print jobs without any error. Memory is especially important if you are printing graphics-heavy colour documents. If your printer doesn't have enough memory to handle these jobs, your computer may become slow. Some laser printers allow you to add memory later—so look for one that supports memory upgrades.

Connections: Check whether the printer comes with the correct cables to connect with your computer. Printers commonly use USB 2.0 to connect to a single computer or, in the case of network laser printers, a network connection cable is required.